Cyclistic: How Casual Riders and Members Ride Differently

Adam Heller | November 2026

Analysis for Lily Moreno's marketing team

Lily Moreno's team needs to decide where, when, and how to promote memberships

We compared casual riders and members on when, where they start, how long they ride, and which bike type they use

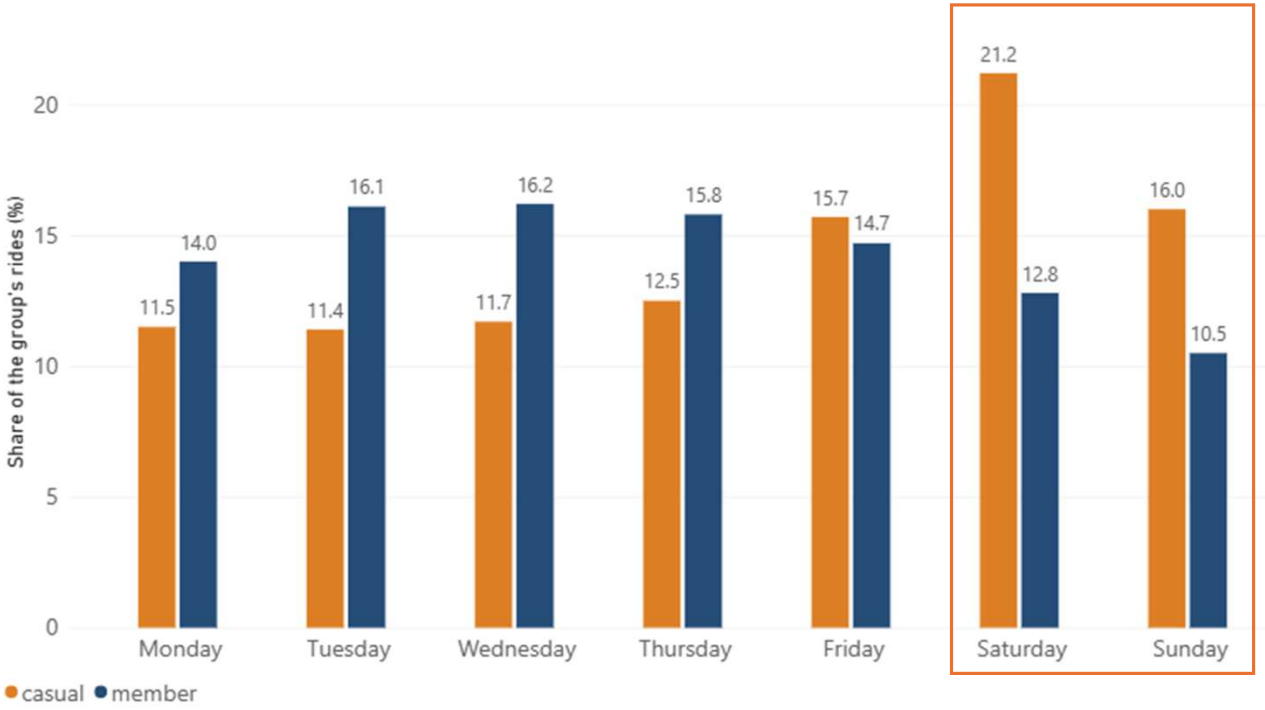
Out of scope: individual riders, why people buy and whether a promotion worked. (no rider IDs, surveys or sign-up records)

6.17M rides cleaned to 6.0M, and every removed row is accounted for

Step	Rows removed
Duplicate rides (in two files)	35
Started before Oct 1, 2025	71
Negative length (time change)	29
Over 24 hours (system-closed)	5,304
Under 60 seconds (false starts)	159,192

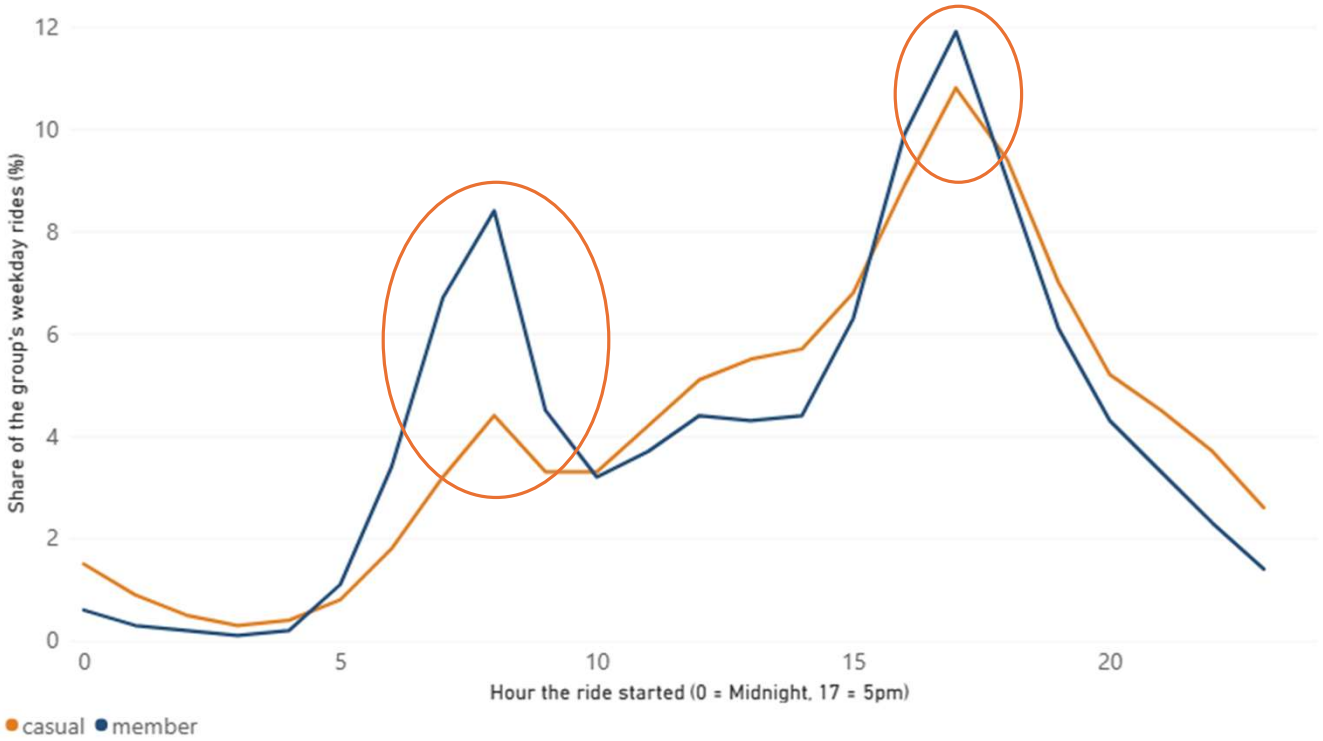
Total removed: 164,631 (2.7%). 6,007,154 rides analyzed. Findings hold with the short rides kept.

37% of casual rides happen on weekends vs. 23% of member rides



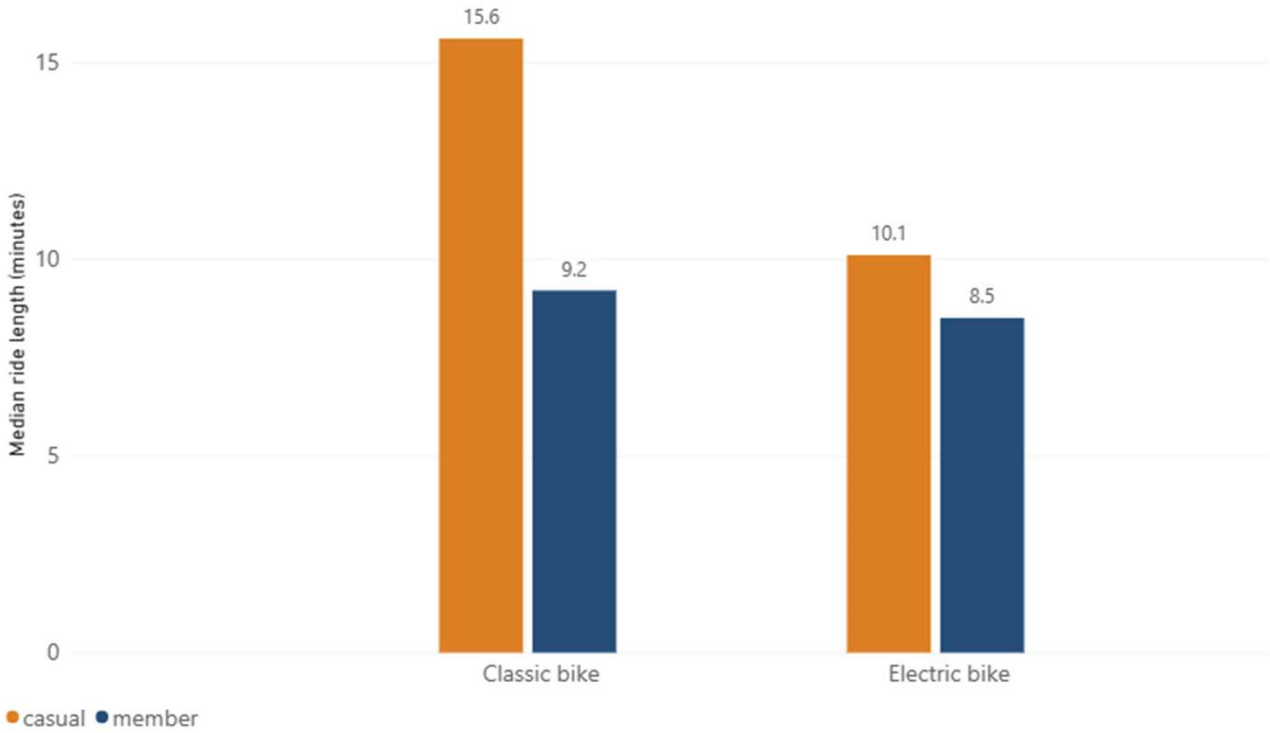
Oct 2025 to Sep 2026, 6.0M rides after cleaning. Bars show each group's share of its own rides. In absolute terms members still take more weekend rides (906K vs. 785K).

At 8am members start 8.4% of weekday rides vs. 4.4% for casuals; by 5pm the groups look alike



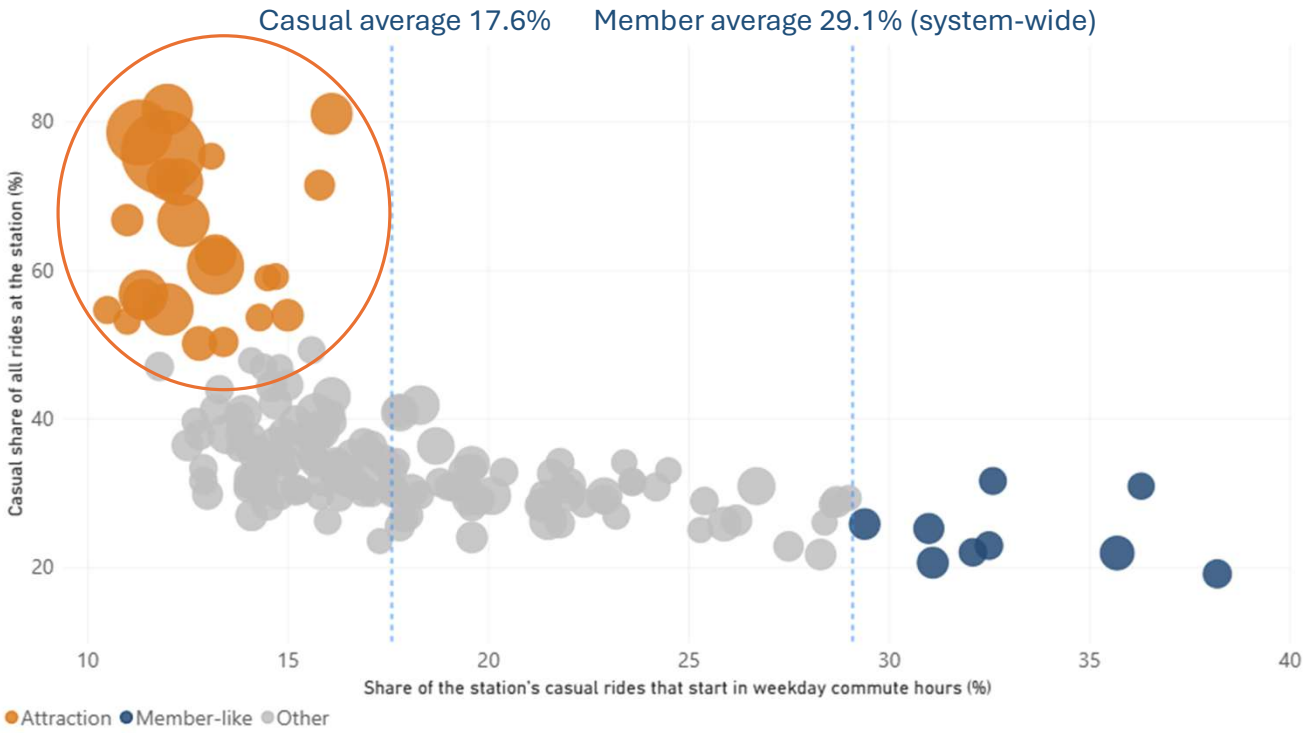
Weekdays only: 3.0M member rides, 1.3M casual rides. Lines show each group's share of its own rides.

On classic bikes the typical casual ride is 70% longer than a member's; on e-bikes it's only 19% longer



Medians. Excludes rides under 60 seconds or over 24 hours. Classic bikes are 26% of casual rides and 32% of member rides.

23 attraction stations hold 15.7% of docked casual rides, but only 12.4% of those rides start in weekday commute hours



Docked starts only (about 80% of rides); stations with 3,000+ casual rides; dot size = casual rides. Commute hours = weekday starts 7-9am and 4-6pm. Member-like stations (9) hold only 2.4% of casual rides. Member average (29.1%) is system-wide.

What this can’t tell us, and the data that would

Limits

- Rides, not riders: no rider IDs
- Shows how groups differ, not why
- Station charts cover docked rides only (about 80%)

Data that would strengthen this

- Pass-purchase records linked to anonymous rider IDs
- Sign-ups from the two promotion tests
- Rider surveys on trip purpose and why people buy

Test first, then roll out: three recommendations

- **Test 1:** Promote memberships at the 23 attraction stations on summer weekend afternoons.
- **Test 2:** Promote at the 9 member-like stations during weekday commute hours (7-9am, 4-6pm).
- **Measure:** Count sign-ups per 1,000 riders reached vs. control stations with no promotion.